As Mohammad Yousuf walks in, another cricketer as heralded and majestic as the others, a self-belief washes through my system. Inzamam looked exactly like those club cricketers playing Burnley that year. I'd bowled the same ball at them too and seen them respond exactly the same way. My best ball was good enough for the best. I don't think I'd ever had proof of it before. Now I do, there is a transformation that takes place in me, a rush of endorphins which somehow switches some vital part of my DNA, telling me I might just belong. As I run in with the next ball, I remember the team meeting the night before. The plan for Yousuf is full and straight, first up. I can do that. I reach for the magic ball, program it into my system, tell the ball what I want it to do. Again, I know, even before it leaves my hand, that it is going to be a good one. It's perfect – a spearing yorker that appears again to be heading down the leg side, then, like a homing missile, 90 miles an hour, straightens at the last minute, leaving Yousuf to force his bat down at the wrong angle while stuck on the crease. I don't see, his body obstructing the angle, taut and guessing still, but I hear the stumps hit. I'm running towards him, helicoptering my arms, screaming and screaming, running into the arms of cricketers I had not even imagined to be real people until recently – Alec Stewart, Marcus Trescothick, Craig White – looking back at them as they ruffle my hair and laugh in my face. If I could have told the boy on that bench in Burnley, with that ham sandwich, I would. But I was something different now, a trajectory taking me elsewhere. It doesn't strike me then, but it will one day, that the boy on the bench is called James. James is the one there still longing, still feeling quite sensitive about everything, worried about social interactions, working out the world. The name they are singing in the crowds now, that's someone else. 'Jimmy' is the person with the ball in his hand.

And in this new skin, it occurs to me as we leave the pitch how much the goalposts have just changed in my life, because as my dad congratulated me against the backdrop of a huge statement of a win against global giants, all I can think about is getting the last ball of my spell wrong, it going for four and Nasser shouting, from behind me at mid-on 'Fuuuuck'.

There was a new territory that came with this world, with this success, and it was the shifting sand of nothing, ever, being enough.